

Absolutely — **branch** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...I would not be surprised if it opened another **branch** one day.”

Here **branch** means **one local outlet or office belonging to a larger business or organisation**. But the word also has major meanings involving **tree branches, divisions of organisations, fields of knowledge, parts of government, and branching structures**.

Word family: **branch / branched / branching**

Base word: branch

Verb forms: branch, branches, branched, branching

Related forms: branching

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **branch = local outlet of a business — 分店 ; 分行**

Your sentence:

> “...if it opened another **branch** one day.”

Here **branch** means:

> **one local shop, office, or operating unit belonging to a larger business or organisation.**

繁體中文 :

屬於同一間公司或機構、設於另一地點的一個營業單位 ; 分店、分行、分部

Natural translation:

> “...if it opened another branch one day.”

「.....如果它有一天再開一間**分店**，我也不會感到意外。」

So here:

> **branch = 同一品牌 / 機構在另一地點開設的分店**

1. **branch = part of a tree growing from the trunk — 樹枝 ; 枝幹**

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “A bird was sitting on a **branch**.”

「一隻鳥停在一根**樹枝**上。」

Practice 2

> “The storm broke several branches.”

「暴風雨折斷了幾根**樹枝**。」

branch = 從樹幹伸出的較大型木質枝條

2. **branch** = local office/shop of a business or organisation — 分店；分行；分部

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The bakery may open another **branch**.”

「這間麵包店可能會再開一間**分店**。」

Practice 4

> “The bank has several branches across the city.”

「這間銀行在全市有幾間**分行**。」

branch = 同一企業 / 機構在不同地點設立的營業或服務單位

Natural Chinese:

* shop/business → 分店

* bank → 分行

* organisation → 分部

3. **branch** = division of an organisation — 分部；部門；支部

A broader institutional sense.

Practice 5

> “She works for the local **branch** of the charity.”

「她在這個慈善機構的本地**分部**工作。」

Practice 6

> “The union opened a new regional branch.”

「工會成立了一個新的地區**支部**。」

branch = 一個大型組織內按地區或功能劃分的分支單位

4. **branch** = field or subdivision of knowledge — 分支；學科分支

A major academic sense.

Practice 7

> “Biology has many different **branches**.”

「生物學有很多不同的**分支**。」

Practice 8

> “Linguistics is a branch of language study.”

「語言學是語言研究的一個**分支**。」

branch = 一個較大知識領域中的專門子領域

Common:

* branch of science

* branch of mathematics

* branch of medicine

5. **branch** = division of government — 政府部門；權力分支

A major political/institutional sense.

Practice 9

> “The judicial **branch** interprets the law.”

「司法**部門** / 權力分支**負責解釋法律**。」

Practice 10

> “The three branches of government have different roles.”

「政府的三個**權力分支**各有不同職能。」

branch = 政府體系中按權力 / 職能區分的主要部分

Common:

* executive branch

* legislative branch

* judicial branch

6. **branch = side division of a road/river/network — 支流；支線；分岔部分**

A major structural extension.

Practice 11

> “This river has several smaller **branches**.”

「這條河有幾條較小的**支流 / 分支水道**。」

Practice 12

> “The railway branch connects the town to the main line.”

「這條鐵路**支線**把小鎮連接到主線。」

branch = 從主體分出去的一條較小路線、河道或連接部分

7. **branch = family line / subdivision of a family — 家族支系；分支**

A useful genealogical sense.

Practice 13

> “They belong to a different **branch** of the family.”

「他們屬於家族的另一個**支系**。」

Practice 14

> “That branch of the family moved overseas.”

「那個家族**分支**搬到海外去了。」

branch = 同一家族內由不同後代形成的支系

8. **branch** = verb, divide into smaller parts — 分支；分岔

A major verb sense.

Practice 15

> “The road **branches** near the village.”

「道路在村莊附近**分岔**。」

Practice 16

> “The river branches into two channels.”

「河流**分成**兩條水道。」

branch — verb = 主體在某點分成兩個或以上較小部分

9. **branch** = verb, expand into a new area/activity — 擴展到；拓展業務

A figurative business/general extension.

Practice 17

> “The bakery may **branch** into catering.”

「這間麵包店可能會**拓展到**餐飲外燴業務。」

Practice 18

> “The company branched into online sales.”

「公司**拓展到網上銷售**。」

****branch into = 從原本活動 / 業務擴展到另一個新領域****

This is technically a phrasal construction, so under your SOP I'd flag it rather than overdevelop it.

10. ****branching = dividing into multiple paths — 分支；分岔結構****

A useful related noun/adjective.

Practice 19

> “The diagram shows a ****branching**** structure.”

「這個圖表顯示一個****分支結構****。」

Practice 20

> “The tree has a complex branching pattern.”

「這棵樹有複雜的****分枝模式****。」

****branching = 一個結構由主體向多個方向分開的形式****

11. ****branch line = 支線****

A useful transport compound.

Practice 21

> “The village is served by a railway ****branch line****.”

「這條村有一條鐵路****支線****連接。」

Practice 22

> “The branch line joins the main railway farther north.”

「這條**支線**在更北面接上主鐵路。」

branch line = 從主要鐵路 / 交通路線分出去的次要路線

12. **branch office = 分公司 ; 分部辦事處**

Practice 23

> “The company opened a new **branch office**.”

「公司開設了一個新的**分公司 / 分部辦事處**。」

Practice 24

> “She manages the regional branch office.”

「她負責管理地區**分部辦事處**。」

branch office = 大型公司 / 機構在另一地點設立的辦事處

Important distinction: **branch vs shop/store**

branch

= one outlet belonging to a wider business/organisation.

shop/store

= the physical retail place itself.

A branch can be:

- * a shop
- * a bank office
- * an organisation office

So:

> bakery branch

> = 麵包店分店

> shop

> = 商店本身

Important distinction: **branch vs franchise**

branch

usually owned/controlled directly by the same organisation.

franchise

usually operated by a separate owner under licence to use the brand/business model.

So:

> company-owned branch

> = 公司直營分店

> franchise outlet

> = 特許經營店

Important business distinction.

Important distinction: **branch vs outlet**

branch

emphasizes organisational connection to a parent business.

outlet

emphasizes a place where goods/services are sold.

> bank branch

> = 銀行分行

> retail outlet

> = 零售點

They overlap for shops, but not always.

Important distinction: **branch vs department**

branch

often:

- * geographically separate
- * structurally one division of a larger whole

department

usually:

- * functional division within an organisation

> Hong Kong branch

> = 香港分部

> marketing department

> = 市場部

Important distinction: **branch vs division**

branch

often suggests a natural or organisational offshoot.

division

more formal:

a defined organisational unit.

> local branch

> = 地區分部

> corporate division

> = 公司事業部

Important distinction: **branch vs field**

branch of science

= one subdivision within a broader academic field.

field

= the broader subject area itself.

> physics is a field

> quantum physics is a branch/subfield

So:

> field = 領域

> branch = 分支

Important distinction: **branch vs limb**

branch

= part of a tree.

limb

can mean:

* large tree branch

* human/animal arm or leg

> tree branch

> = 樹枝

> tree limb

> = 大枝幹

Limb is broader anatomically.

Important distinction: **branch vs twig**

branch

= larger woody part.

twig

= very small thin branch.

> branch

> = 枝幹 / 樹枝

> twig

> = 小枝 / 細枝

Important distinction: **branch vs root**

Direct structural contrast:

branch

extends outward/upward from the trunk.

root

extends into the ground.

Figuratively:

* branch = 分支、發展出去

* root = 根源、起源

Important distinction: **branch — physical vs organisational**

Physical:

> “a branch of a tree”

= 樹枝

Organisational:

> “a branch of a bank”

= 銀行分行

Same underlying metaphor:

> ****main trunk → smaller offshoot****

That conceptual connection explains many uses.

Important distinction: ****branch — organisation vs knowledge****

Organisation:

> local branch

> = 地區分部

Knowledge:

> branch of science

> = 科學分支

Same structural metaphor, different domain.

Important distinction: ****branch — noun vs verb****

Noun:

> “The bank opened a branch.”

= 銀行開了分行。

Verb:

> “The road branches here.”

= 道路在這裡分岔。

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* ****branch — tree**** = 樹枝 / 枝幹

* ****branch — business outlet**** = 分店 / 分行

* ****branch — organisation division**** = 分部 / 支部

* ****branch — academic field**** = 學科分支

* **branch — government** = 政府權力分支 / 部門
 * **branch — route/river/network** = 支流 / 支線 / 分支
 * **branch — family line** = 家族支系
 * **branch — verb: divide** = 分岔 / 分支
 * **branch into** = 拓展到新領域
 * **branching** = 分支結構 / 分岔
 * **branch line** = 支線
 * **branch office** = 分公司 / 分部辦事處

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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branch — tree	從樹幹伸出的較大型木質枝條
branch — business	同一企業在另一地點設立的營業 / 服務單位
branch — organisation	大型組織內按地區或功能劃分的分支單位
branch — academic	較大知識領域中的一個專門子領域
branch — government	政府體系中按權力 / 職能區分的主要部分
branch — route/river	從主線 / 主流分出去的較小路線或水道
branch — family	同一家族內由不同後代形成的支系
branch — verb	主體在某點分成兩個或以上較小部分
branch into	從原本活動 / 業務拓展到另一個新領域
branching	一個結構由主體向多個方向分開的形式
branch line	從主要交通路線分出去的次要支線
branch office	公司 / 機構在另一地點設立的分部辦事處

For your original sentence

> “Looking ahead, I would not be surprised if it opened another **branch** one day.”

The exact meaning is:

branch = Golden Crust 在另一個地點開設、但仍屬於同一品牌和生意體系的一間新分店。 ******

Natural translation:

> ******「展望將來，我完全不會意外它有一天再開一間分店。」 ******

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **tree branch** → 樹枝
- > **bakery branch** → 麵包店分店
- > **bank branch** → 銀行分行
- > **local branch of an organisation** → 地區分部 / 支部

- > **branch of science** → 學科分支
- > **branch of government** → 政府權力分支
- > **railway branch** → 鐵路支線
- > **branch of a family** → 家族支系
- > **road branches** → 道路分岔